

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the paralegal role at EMG Solicitors in Reading. EMG's focus on Court of Protection, Mental Health Law and Dispute Resolution connects directly with the client-facing and case management work I have been doing at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, where I advise vulnerable clients daily on welfare benefits, housing, employment and debt matters.

At Citizens Advice I manage matters from initial instruction through to submission. That means taking detailed factual statements, identifying evidential gaps, drafting correspondence and applications, and maintaining confidential case records while juggling competing deadlines across an active caseload. Many of my clients are in difficult personal circumstances, so I have had to develop real judgement about how to communicate complex procedural rules clearly and sensitively without losing accuracy. That combination of case administration rigour and client-facing communication is, I think, directly relevant to the kind of work EMG does across its vulnerable-client practice areas.

Before Citizens Advice, I spent a year at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner as a placement student, split between International Arbitration and Real Estate Disputes. In the arbitration team I coordinated documents, tracked procedural deadlines and helped prepare the Claimant's memorial ahead of a significant submission deadline, at a point when I was the only junior supporting the team. In the disputes team I reviewed documents, prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court filings. Both rotations gave me structured experience of managing large volumes of confidential material across several matters at once, which I continued developing through my LLM at Queen Mary, where I completed research on cross-jurisdictional data protection and procedural issues in dispute resolution.

What draws me to EMG specifically is the breadth of its practice alongside that clear focus on genuinely helping clients through difficult situations. My background has developed across several of EMG's core areas, and I want to build on it in a firm where the work is varied and where client outcomes are taken seriously. I am based in Maidenhead and the Reading office is an easy commute, which means I can commit fully from day one.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva